

Product Requirements Document

Photography Portfolio & Booking Website

Version	1.0	Date	August 14, 2026
Prepared for	[Photographer / Business Name]		

1. Overview

A single-page (or lightly multi-page) photography portfolio website that showcases the photographer's work and lets visitors request a booking. No visitor account, no payment processing, and no backend database are required for v1 — booking requests reach the photographer directly via a pre-filled SMS text (from the visitor's own phone) or email.

Core principle: Keep it fast, visually striking, mobile-first, and zero/low-cost to run (static site, no server needed for v1).

2. Goals

Goal	Description
Showcase work	Present photography in a gallery that feels premium and lets images breathe
Generate leads	Make it effortless for a visitor to reach out about rates/availability
Zero-friction booking	Booking button opens the visitor's own messaging app with a pre-filled text — no server, no SMS API cost
Brand identity	Distinct visual identity built around the supplied gradient color palette, not a generic template look
Mobile-first	Majority of traffic will be mobile (Instagram/WhatsApp referrals)

3. Target Users

- **Primary:** Prospective clients browsing on mobile, discovering the site via Instagram/WhatsApp/word of mouth, who want to quickly see work and inquire.
- **Secondary:** Repeat/referred clients checking rates or specific shoot categories (e.g., "wedding," "portrait").

4. Visual & Brand Direction

Based on the two reference images supplied:

- **Palette A (dark/moody):** Deep charcoal-black base with glowing gradient blooms of magenta/pink, warm gold, and violet-lavender. Grainy/film-noise texture.
- **Palette B (warm/vivid):** Sunset pink fading to peach/orange, undercut by a deep blue-violet pool at the base. Same grainy texture.

Recommended direction: Use Palette A (dark charcoal base) as the primary site theme — it lets photography pop, feels premium/editorial, and works beautifully as a hero backdrop. Palette B's warm gradient can be used as an accent (buttons, hover states, section dividers, the booking CTA) for contrast and energy.

Design language:

- Generous negative space, large full-bleed images
- Grain/noise texture overlay on gradient sections, matching the reference images
- Minimal, elegant serif or high-contrast sans-serif type for headings; clean sans for body
- Smooth scroll, subtle fade-in animations on images
- Gradient used sparingly and intentionally (hero background, CTA button, section transitions)

This PRD assumes the direction above until exact hex color codes are supplied.

5. Site Structure (Pages / Sections)

Recommend a single scrollable landing page with anchor navigation (fastest to build, best for mobile, easiest to maintain) rather than multiple separate pages:

- **Hero** — Full-screen gradient/photo background, photographer name/brand, tagline, primary CTA ("Book a Session")
- **About** — Short bio, photo of the photographer, style philosophy
- **Portfolio/Gallery** — Filterable by category (Portraits, Weddings, Events, Products, Nature); masonry or grid layout with lightbox
- **Services & Rates** — Package cards (Basic / Standard / Premium) with what's included and pricing
- **Testimonials** — Optional, if available
- **Booking / Contact section** — The core conversion point (see Section 6)
- **Footer** — Social links, copyright, alternate contact info

6. Booking Flow — Core Feature

How it works (no backend/server/API cost):

- Visitor fills a short form: Name, Phone Number, Preferred Date, Shoot Type (dropdown), Message (optional)
- Visitor clicks "Send Booking Request"
- **SMS option:** Opens the visitor's own messaging app via an sms : link, addressed to the photographer's number, with the form details pre-filled as the message body. Visitor just taps Send.
- **Email option (fallback):** A mailto : link opens the visitor's email app pre-filled with subject/body.
- **Call Now button:** A simple tel : link for visitors who'd rather call directly.

Why this approach:

- Requires no paid SMS gateway (e.g. Twilio), no server, no database — purely static/client-side
- Photographer receives genuine texts/calls/emails directly, with the client's number visible, for easy call-back
- Trade-off: reliable mainly on mobile devices; desktop visitors are covered by the email/call fallback

Future upgrade path (v2, optional): Guaranteed SMS from any device (including desktop) requires a lightweight backend (e.g., a serverless function calling Twilio's SMS API) with a small recurring cost (~\$0.0079/text + phone number rental). Not required for launch.

7. Functional Requirements

#	Requirement
1	Responsive design — mobile, tablet, desktop
2	Image gallery with lightbox (click to enlarge, swipe/arrow navigation)
3	Gallery filtering by category
4	Booking form with client-side validation (required fields, phone format check)

#	Requirement
5	SMS, mailto, and tel deep-link generation from form data
6	Services/rates section, easily editable
7	Social media links (Instagram, WhatsApp, etc.)
8	Fast image loading (lazy-load, compressed/optimized images)
9	SEO basics — page title, meta description, alt text on images
10	Analytics-ready (optional Google Analytics/Plausible snippet slot)

8. Non-Functional Requirements

- **Performance:** Page load under ~2.5s on 4G; images lazy-loaded and compressed (WebP)
- **Hosting:** Static site — deployable free/cheap on Netlify, Vercel, GitHub Pages, or similar
- **Accessibility:** Reasonable color contrast despite dark theme, alt text on all images, keyboard-navigable form
- **Browser support:** Latest Chrome, Safari, Firefox, Edge; iOS Safari and Android Chrome specifically tested
- **Maintainability:** Gallery images and rates should be easy to update without touching code

9. Recommended Tech Stack

Layer	Recommendation	Why
Frontend	HTML/CSS/JS (or React for future interactivity)	No backend needed for v1; keeps hosting free
Styling	Custom CSS with the gradient/grain design system	Matches the distinctive visual direction
Hosting	Netlify or Vercel (free tier)	Free, fast, easy custom domain setup
Forms	Client-side only (sms:/mailto:/tel: links)	Zero cost, no backend
Images	Optimized WebP, lazy-loaded	Fast load on mobile
Domain	Custom domain (e.g. yourname.com)	Optional but recommended for credibility

10. Information Still Needed From You

- Business/photographer name and tagline
- Booking phone number (the one that should receive texts) and email
- Exact color hex codes, if you have specific ones in mind, or confirmation to extract them from the two reference images
- Photos for the gallery (organized by category if possible), or confirmation to use placeholders for now
- Services & pricing — package names, what's included, prices (or "contact for quote")
- Bio/About text and a headshot, if desired
- Social media handles to link
- Logo, if you have one (or should one be designed as part of this?)

11. Implementation Plan

Phase 1 — Foundation (Day 1–2)

- Set up project structure, choose hosting, register domain (if applicable)
- Build design system: color variables, typography, spacing, grain-texture background component
- Build responsive layout skeleton (hero, nav, sections, footer)

Phase 2 — Core Pages (Day 2–4)

- Hero section with gradient background + headline
- About section
- Gallery component with category filtering + lightbox
- Services/rates cards

Phase 3 — Booking Flow (Day 4–5)

- Build booking form UI
- Wire up sms:, mailto:, and tel: link generation from form fields
- Form validation (required fields, phone number format)
- Test on real iOS and Android devices (SMS deep-links behave differently per platform)

Phase 4 — Content & Polish (Day 5–6)

- Load in real photos, bio, rates, social links
- Fine-tune animations, transitions, image loading performance
- Cross-browser and cross-device QA (iPhone Safari, Android Chrome, desktop)
- SEO basics: meta tags, alt text, favicon

Phase 5 — Launch (Day 6–7)

- Deploy to hosting (Netlify/Vercel)
- Connect custom domain + SSL
- Final end-to-end test of the booking flow (submit a real test booking)
- Optional: connect analytics

Phase 6 — Optional Future Upgrades

- True server-side SMS (Twilio) so desktop visitors can also trigger a real text automatically
- CMS integration so photos/rates can be updated without code
- Client testimonials with photo uploads
- Instagram feed embed
- Blog/journal section for SEO

12. Success Metrics (Optional, for later)

- Number of booking-form submissions per month
- Gallery engagement (images viewed per session)
- Mobile vs desktop traffic split
- Bounce rate on hero section

13. Open Questions

- Single scrolling page, or separate pages (Home / Portfolio / Rates / Contact)?
- Should pricing be publicly listed, or "contact for quote"?
- Any specific photographers' or studios' websites you like the feel of, for reference?